Workshop 1.3: Gender, Inclusion & Digital Rights Foundation

Phase 1: Digital Foundations

Workshop Code: WS 1.3
Primary Component: Cross-cutting (All Components)
Duration: 1.5 days
Timing: Month 3, Week 2-3
Phase Theme: "Building Trust & Infrastructure"

Executive Summary

This critical workshop embeds gender, inclusion, and digital rights principles into the DNA of Trinidad & Tobago's digital transformation from the outset. Rather than treating these as add-ons, the workshop establishes frameworks and commitments that will be woven through all subsequent project activities. Participants will explore inclusive design principles, accessibility standards, privacy protections, and strategies to ensure that e-ID, interoperability, and data centre initiatives serve all citizens equitably—particularly marginalized populations including women, youth, persons with disabilities, and those facing economic barriers.

Key Outcome: Actionable Gender, Inclusion, and Diversity (GID) framework integrated into all three project components with measurable commitments.

Workshop Objectives

Primary Objectives

1. **Establish GID Framework:** Create practical framework for embedding gender and inclusion principles across all project components
2. **Inclusive Design Standards:** Define accessibility and universal design requirements for e-ID and digital services
3. **Digital Rights Protections:** Align with international standards on privacy, data protection, and digital rights
4. **Address Digital Divides:** Identify barriers to digital access and develop mitigation strategies

5. **Empower Vulnerable Populations:** Design specific interventions for women facing GBV, persons with disabilities, elderly, rural populations

Secondary Objectives

- Learn from EU best practices (GDPR, accessibility directives)
- Build capacity within project team on GID principles
- Establish monitoring and accountability mechanisms
- Create stakeholder coalition for ongoing advocacy

Target Participants (30-40 people)

Core Stakeholders (Required)

- **MPAAI Project Team** (6-8)
- All component leads (e-ID, interoperability, data centre)
- Gender focal points
- Policy and legal advisors
- **Gender & Women's Rights Organizations** (6-8)
- Women's rights advocacy groups
- Gender-based violence support services
- Women in technology organizations
- LGBTQ+ rights organizations
- **Disability Rights Organizations** (4-6)
- Organizations representing persons with disabilities
- Accessibility advocates
- Assistive technology specialists

Extended Stakeholders (Important)

- **Civil Society Organizations** (4-6)
- Human rights organizations
- Digital rights advocates
- Community development organizations
- Youth organizations
- **Academic & Research** (3-4)

- Gender studies researchers
- Human-computer interaction specialists

- Digital sociology experts

- **Legal & Regulatory** (2-3)

- Data protection authority representatives
- Privacy lawyers

- Constitutional rights experts

- **Service Delivery MDAs** (3-4)

- Ministry of Social Development (social services)
- Ministry of Health (health services, GBV response)
- Ministry of Education
- Agencies serving vulnerable populations

Expert Resources

- **EU Gender & Digital Rights Experts** (2-3)
- GDPR and data protection specialist
- EU accessibility directive expert

- Gender and technology researcher

- **Regional Experts** (1-2)

- Caribbean gender advocates with digital expertise

- **CAF & EU Delegation** (2)

Detailed Agenda

DAY 1: Frameworks, Rights & Inclusive Design

Morning Session (9:00 AM - 12:30 PM)

9:00 - 9:30 | Opening & Setting the Context
- Welcome by MPAAI leadership
- **Why This Matters:** Personal stories/testimonials
- Woman accessing GBV services needing privacy
- Person with visual impairment navigating government services
- Elderly citizen struggling with digital literacy

- Youth advocate for digital rights
- Workshop objectives and participatory ground rules

9:30 - 10:45 | Digital Rights & International Standards
- **Presentation:** "Digital Rights as Human Rights" (30 min)
- UN frameworks (Universal Declaration of Human Rights in digital age)
- Right to privacy
- Right to non-discrimination
- Right to access information
- Data protection as fundamental right

• **Presentation:** "EU Digital Rights Framework" (25 min)
• GDPR principles and applicability
• EU Accessibility Directive
• Gender equality in digital services

• Lessons for Trinidad & Tobago

• **Interactive Discussion:** "T&T Digital Rights Charter" (20 min)

• What rights should be guaranteed?
• How do we protect vulnerable populations?
• Enforcement mechanisms

10:45 - 11:00 | BREAK

11:00 - 12:30 | Gender & Digital Transformation
- **Presentation:** "Gender Dimensions of Digital Identity" (25 min)
- Gender data gaps
- Identity systems and gender-based violence (privacy concerns)
- Transgender and non-binary considerations
- Economic empowerment through digital access
- Women in tech sector development

• **Case Studies:** "Gender-Responsive Digital Services" (30 min)
• Estonia: Secure access to services for abuse survivors
• India: Gender considerations in Aadhaar
• Rwanda: Women's economic empowerment through digital ID

• Nordic countries: Gender mainstreaming in e-government

• **Small Group Discussions:** "Gender Impact Analysis" (30 min)

• **Group 1:** e-ID program gender implications
• **Group 2:** Interoperability and women's service access
• **Group 3:** Data centre jobs and skills (gender equity)
• **Group 4:** Privacy and safety for vulnerable women

Each group identifies:
- Potential risks/harms
- Opportunities for empowerment
- Design requirements
- Safeguards needed

- **Report Back** (15 min)

12:30 - 1:30 PM | LUNCH

Afternoon Session (1:30 PM - 5:00 PM)

1:30 - 3:15 | Accessibility & Universal Design
- **Presentation:** "Universal Design for Digital Services" (30 min)
- Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG 2.1)
- Assistive technologies (screen readers, voice recognition)
- Cognitive accessibility
- Low-literacy design
- Multi-modal interfaces
- Mobile-first for underserved populations

- **Interactive Demo:** "Experiencing Digital Barriers" (30 min)
- Participants use assistive technologies
- Navigate inaccessible websites with blindfold/one hand
- Low-bandwidth simulations

- Empathy-building exercise

- **Panel Discussion:** "Lived Experiences of Digital Exclusion" (30 min)

- Persons with disabilities share experiences
- Rural/underserved community representatives
- Elderly users
- Low-digital-literacy citizens

- Q&A and discussion

- **Workshop:** "Accessible e-ID Design" (15 min)

- Apply accessibility principles to e-ID use cases from WS 1.1
- Identify accessibility requirements for each component

3:15 - 3:30 | BREAK

3:30 - 5:00 | Addressing Digital Divides
- **Presentation:** "Digital Divides in Trinidad & Tobago" (20 min)
- Current data on digital access (urban/rural, gender, age, income)
- Device ownership gaps

- Connectivity gaps
- Digital literacy gaps
- Intersectionality (multiple marginalization)

- **Breakout Sessions:** "Bridging the Divides" (50 min)
- **Group 1:** Connectivity & Device Access
    - Public access points (libraries, community centres)
    - Affordable device programs
    - Offline-capable services
- **Group 2:** Digital Literacy & Skills
    - Training programs (gender-sensitive)
    - Multilingual support
    - Plain language requirements
    - Community ambassadors model
- **Group 3:** Trust & Safety
    - Building trust in digital systems
    - Protecting against fraud and scams
    - GBV survivor safety protocols
    - Data security for vulnerable populations
- **Group 4:** Service Design for Inclusion
    - Multi-channel service delivery (digital + non-digital)
    - Assisted digital services
    - Proxy/caregiver access considerations
- **Report Back & Discussion** (20 min)

5:00 | Day 1 Close
- Reflection on day's learning
- Preview Day 2

DAY 2: Implementation, Monitoring & Accountability

Morning Session (9:00 AM - 12:00 PM)

9:00 - 9:15 | Day 1 Recap

9:15 - 10:45 | Privacy, Data Protection & Consent
- **Presentation:** "Data Protection Framework" (30 min)
- GDPR principles applied to T&T context

- Data minimization (collect only what's needed)
- Purpose limitation
- Consent requirements (informed, freely given, specific)
- Right to access, correction, deletion
- Data breach protocols
- Children's data protection

- **Interactive Exercise:** "Privacy Impact Assessment" (45 min)
- Walk through privacy impact assessment for e-ID system
- Identify privacy risks
- Design mitigation measures

- Special considerations for sensitive populations

- **Q&A** (15 min)

10:45 - 11:00 | BREAK

11:00 - 12:00 | GID Framework for the Project
- **Presentation:** "Gender, Inclusion & Diversity Framework" (15 min)
- Framework structure
- Principles and commitments
- Application across three components
- Integration into project lifecycle

- **Collaborative Workshop:** "Building Our GID Framework" (40 min)
- Plenary session working together to draft framework
- Core principles
- Specific commitments for each component:
    - e-ID Program
    - Interoperability Platform
    - Data Centre Expansion

- Cross-cutting commitments

- **Review & Refinement** (5 min)

12:00 - 12:45 PM | LUNCH

Afternoon Session (12:45 PM - 4:00 PM)

12:45 - 2:00 PM | Monitoring, Evaluation & Accountability
- **Presentation:** "Gender-Responsive M&E" (20 min)
- Sex-disaggregated data collection
- Gender-sensitive indicators

- Accessibility metrics
- Participatory monitoring

- **Workshop:** "Defining Our Indicators" (45 min)
- Small groups develop indicators:
  - **Group 1:** e-ID Program Indicators
  - % women users, persons with disabilities
  - Accessibility compliance scores
  - Privacy incidents
  - User satisfaction (disaggregated)
  - **Group 2:** Interoperability Platform Indicators
  - Services accessible to all populations
  - Multi-channel availability
  - User support requests (by demographic)
  - **Group 3:** Data Centre Indicators
  - % women in tech jobs created
  - Energy/environmental justice metrics
  - Equitable MDA access to infrastructure
  - **Group 4:** Cross-cutting Indicators
  - Training participation (disaggregated)
  - Stakeholder representation in governance
  - Complaint/feedback mechanisms usage
- **Report Back** (10 min)

2:00 - 2:15 | BREAK

2:15 - 3:30 | Governance & Accountability Mechanisms
- **Panel Discussion:** "Ensuring Accountability" (30 min)
- How do we ensure commitments are kept?
- Role of civil society oversight
- Government accountability structures
- Independent audits and reviews
- Complaint and redress mechanisms

- **Workshop:** "Governance Structure" (40 min)
- Design accountability mechanisms:
  - GID Advisory Committee (membership, mandate)

    - Regular reporting requirements
    - Public transparency measures
    - Community feedback channels
    - Annual GID audit

- Draft terms of reference for GID Advisory Committee

3:30 - 4:00 | Action Planning & Closing
- **Action Planning** (15 min)
- Immediate next steps
- Integration into upcoming workshops (2.1, 2.2, 2.3, etc.)
- Capacity building needs
- Communication strategy

- **Commitments & Pledges** (10 min)
- Participants make public commitments

- MPAAI leadership commitment statement

- **Workshop Evaluation & Closing Remarks** (5 min)

Key Discussion Questions

Rights & Ethics Questions

- How do we balance identity verification security with privacy rights?
- What safeguards prevent digital identity from becoming surveillance?
- How do we protect the most vulnerable while providing universal access?
- What consent mechanisms are truly informed and freely given?

Gender Questions

- How can digital identity empower women economically and socially?
- What specific risks do women face with digital identity systems?
- How do we design for transgender and non-binary individuals?
- How can we ensure women's participation in tech jobs created by the project?

Accessibility Questions

- What does "accessible to all" truly mean in the T&T context?
- How do we serve populations with low digital literacy?
- What offline alternatives must be maintained?
- How do we design for cognitive and learning disabilities, not just physical?

Implementation Questions

- How do we embed these principles in procurement and contracts?
- What training does the project team need on GID?
- How do we measure success on inclusion goals?
- How do we ensure this isn't just a checkbox exercise?

Expected Outputs & Deliverables

Immediate Outputs (During Workshop)

1. **Gender, Inclusion & Diversity (GID) Framework** for the project
2. Core principles
3. Component-specific commitments (e-ID, interoperability, data centre)
4. Cross-cutting commitments
5. **Digital Rights Charter** (draft principles)
6. **Accessibility Standards & Requirements**
7. Technical standards to be adopted (WCAG 2.1, etc.)
8. Procurement requirements
9. **Gender-Responsive Indicators**
10. Quantitative and qualitative metrics
11. Disaggregation requirements
12. **GID Advisory Committee Terms of Reference** (draft)
13. **Action Plan** for GID integration into all project activities

Post-Workshop Deliverables (2 weeks)

1. **Workshop Report** (Product 3)
2. Executive summary
3. GID Framework (finalized)
4. Accessibility requirements
5. Monitoring framework
6. Governance and accountability mechanisms
7. Next steps

8. **GID Integration Toolkit** (Appendix)

9. Checklist for each workshop
10. Templates for gender impact assessments
11. Accessibility testing protocols

12. Inclusive language guide

13. **Training Plan** (Appendix)

14. GID training for project team
15. Accessibility training for developers
16. Gender-sensitive service design for MDAs

Success Metrics

Participation Metrics

- 50%+ women participants
- Representation from at least 5 civil society organizations
- Persons with disabilities actively participating
- Youth voices included

Engagement Metrics

- 90%+ active participation in framework development
- Concrete commitments from MPAAI leadership
- Advisory committee volunteers identified

Satisfaction Metrics

- 4.5/5 average participant satisfaction
- 95%+ felt their concerns were heard
- 90%+ believe framework will make a difference

Outcome Metrics

- GID Framework adopted by project
- Accessibility standards incorporated into technical specifications
- GID Advisory Committee established within 1 month
- All subsequent workshops integrate GID principles

Connection to Other Workshops

Influences ALL Subsequent Workshops:

This workshop's outputs are integrated into every future workshop:

- **Workshop 2.1 (Interoperability):** Accessibility standards for APIs, inclusive service design
- **Workshop 2.2 (Regional Cooperation):** Gender considerations in cross-border services
- **Workshop 2.3 (Cross-Border e-ID):** Privacy protections in pilot design
- **Workshop 3.1 (Tech Hub):** Women in tech, inclusive innovation ecosystem
- **Workshop 3.2 (Emerging Tech):** Ethical AI, bias prevention, accessible interfaces
- **Workshop 3.3 (Private Sector):** Diversity requirements in partnerships
- **Workshop 3.4 & 4.1 (MDA Showcases):** GID success metrics featured prominently
- **Workshop 4.2 (Governance):** GID principles embedded in final governance framework

Inputs From:

- **Workshop 1.1 (e-ID):** Use cases analyzed through gender lens
- **Workshop 1.2 (Data Centre):** Infrastructure inclusion considerations
- **Pre-workshop consultations with civil society**

Creates:

- **GID Advisory Committee** (ongoing stakeholder engagement mechanism)
- **Integration checklist** used in all project activities
- **Monitoring framework** for Product 2, 4, and 6 reporting

Pre-Workshop Preparation

6 Weeks Before

- [ ] Confirm date and book accessible venue
- [ ] Reach out to civil society organizations
- [ ] Book EU gender/accessibility experts
- [ ] Form diverse planning committee

4 Weeks Before

- [ ] Finalize agenda with civil society input
- [ ] Send invitations emphasizing inclusive participation
- [ ] Arrange sign language interpretation, assistive technologies
- [ ] Identify storytellers for opening session

2 Weeks Before

- [ ] Send pre-reading materials:
- GDPR overview
- WCAG 2.1 introduction
- T&T digital divide data
- Gender and technology case studies
- [ ] Confirm accessibility accommodations for all participants
- [ ] Prepare demo materials for accessibility exercise

1 Week Before

- [ ] Send logistics with accessibility details
- [ ] Test all assistive technologies
- [ ] Prepare materials in multiple formats (large print, digital)
- [ ] Conduct facilitator training on inclusive facilitation

Materials & Resources Needed

Presentation Materials

- PowerPoint slides (also available in accessible formats)
- Video testimonials from diverse users
- Infographics on digital divides and inclusion
- Case study handouts

Participant Materials

- Workshop agenda (large print, digital, Braille if needed)
- GID Framework template
- Accessibility standards reference guide
- Privacy impact assessment template
- Indicator development worksheet
- Notebook and pen (or digital alternatives)

Technology & Accessibility

- Projector with large, high-contrast display
- Assistive listening devices
- Sign language interpreters (2, for rotation)
- Screen readers for demo
- Accessible website examples

- WiFi access
- Captioning for videos
- Multiple microphones for participation

Facilities

- Wheelchair-accessible venue
- Gender-neutral restrooms
- Quiet room for sensory breaks
- Prayer/meditation space
- Nursing room (if needed)

Documentation

- Attendance (with optional demographic data)
- Photo/video consent (with opt-out options)
- Note-takers plus audio recording (for accessibility)
- Photography respecting privacy preferences

Budget Estimate

Category	Item	Estimated Cost
Venue	Accessible venue, 1.5 days + breakout rooms	$2,200
Catering	Coffee breaks (3), lunches (2), dietary accommodations	$3,200
Accessibility	Sign language interpreters, assistive tech rental	$2,500
Travel	EU experts flights & accommodation (2-3 experts)	$16,000
Travel	Regional expert (1-2)	$4,000
Travel	Local CSO participant support (rural areas)	$1,500
Materials	Printing (multiple formats), supplies	$800
Technology	AV equipment, captioning services	$1,500
Childcare	Optional childcare to enable parent participation	$600
Facilitation	Professional facilitator with GID expertise	$4,000
Contingency	10%	$3,630

Category	Item	Estimated Cost
TOTAL		**$39,930**

Risk Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Tokenistic participation (checking box without real commitment)	MPAAI leadership involvement; civil society oversight; concrete accountability mechanisms
Accessibility needs not met	Detailed pre-workshop needs assessment; budget for accommodations; test all equipment
Discussions become too theoretical	Ground in real user stories; practical exercises; link to concrete design decisions
Resistance from technical team ("constraints on design")	Frame as design enhancements, not constraints; show EU examples of successful integration
Framework created but not implemented	Establish Advisory Committee; integrate into procurement; include in M&E; leadership commitment
Insufficient civil society participation	Early outreach; cover travel costs; make venue and timing accessible; value their expertise

Gender & Inclusion Considerations

Representation (THE POINT OF THIS WORKSHOP)

- At least 50% women participants
- Persons with disabilities in leadership roles (presenting, facilitating)
- LGBTQ+ representation
- Age diversity (youth and elderly)
- Geographic diversity (urban and rural)
- Socioeconomic diversity

Content

- Real stories from marginalized populations throughout

- Intersectional analysis (not just gender OR disability, but multiple identities)
- Power dynamics acknowledged and addressed
- Both risks and opportunities highlighted

Process

- Inclusive facilitation (multiple ways to participate)
- Safe space agreements
- Accessibility in all aspects
- Compensate civil society participants for their time and expertise
- Follow-up mechanisms for continued input

Follow-up Actions (Post-Workshop)

Week 1

- [ ] Send thank you emails
- [ ] Establish GID Advisory Committee (first meeting within 2 weeks)
- [ ] Begin drafting workshop report
- [ ] Create GID integration checklist for all future workshops

Week 2

- [ ] Finalize and circulate draft workshop report
- [ ] Share GID Framework with all project staff
- [ ] Schedule GID training for project team
- [ ] Update procurement templates with accessibility/GID requirements

Week 3-4

- [ ] Incorporate feedback and publish final report
- [ ] Submit to CAF and EU as Product 3
- [ ] Brief all component teams on GID integration requirements
- [ ] Plan integration into upcoming workshops (2.1, 2.2, 2.3)

Ongoing (Throughout Project)

- [ ] Quarterly GID Advisory Committee meetings
- [ ] GID lens applied to all procurement
- [ ] Accessibility testing of all digital outputs
- [ ] Gender-disaggregated data collection
- [ ] Annual GID audit (reported in Products 4 and 6)

Links to TOR Requirements

This workshop directly addresses:

TOR Section 5, Cross-Cutting Objectives:
- **Objective D:** "Cross-cutting Gender and Diversity Component: Recommend incorporating gender and diversity considerations into the project's social and legal/ethical aspects, including non-disclosure agreements (NDAs) and sensitive information protocols."

TOR Section 5, Specific Component Actions:
- **Action A.b (e-ID):** "Support the development of software components and API integrations for the e-ID platform with embedded Gender, Inclusion, and Diversity (GID) principles."

TOR Section 6, Services:
- **Service 1:** "Incorporate effective integration of Gender, Inclusion and Diversity considerations across project activities."

TOR Section 7, Products:
- **Product 3:** Workshop Reports

Influences all Products 2, 4, 5, and 6 through the GID monitoring framework established here.

Document Status: Draft for Review
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Date: September 26, 2026
Next Review: 2 weeks before workshop execution

SPECIAL NOTE: This workshop is foundational to the ethical and social success of the entire digital transformation initiative. Its outputs must be treated not as aspirational but as binding commitments integrated into every subsequent project decision.